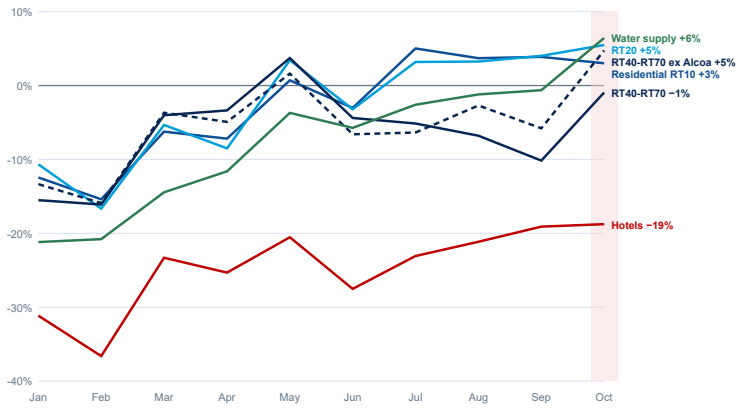
October 2026: are we in recovery mode?

Residential and small commercial are through the recovery. Large commercial is not: hotels are still 19% down, Alcoa has left the grid and the hurricane-hit west is still below last year.

Answer. Recovery mode applies to three things only: **hotels** (the gap to last year has closed from 31% in January to 19%), the **western parishes**, and the **7,742 extra residential customers still at zero kWh**, a number that has not moved since June. Everything else is either back above its pre-storm level (residential, RT20, water) or lower for a structural reason (Alcoa and industrial).

YEAR ON YEAR BY MONTH, 2026 VS 2025



October's comparison is flattered: the October 2025 base includes the storm of 28 October. The shaded column marks it. Prepaid is included.

WHAT THE LINES SAY

- **Residential** has been above last year since July (+5.0%, +3.7%, +3.9%, +3.0%) and is +6.2% on October 2024, the last clean October.
- **RT40 to RT70** widened from −5.1% in July to −10.2% in September. Take Alcoa out and it was −6.4% to −5.8%: the commercial base was still short of last year before October.
- **October's +4.7%** for RT40 to RT70 excluding Alcoa is the storm base, not a turn. Hotels (−18.8%) show what the base is hiding.
- **Water supply** is the one large commercial group fully back (+6.4%).

RECOVERY SCORECARD

Indicator	Now vs comparison	Change	Status
Residential RT10 vs Oct 2024 (pre-storm, postpaid)	106.2 vs 100.0 GWh	+6.2%	Recovered
RT20 vs Oct 2024 (postpaid)	60.8 vs 55.0 GWh	+10.4%	Recovered
RT40 to RT70 vs Oct 2024	124.5 vs 129.0 GWh	−3.5%	Not recovered
RT40 to RT70 ex Alcoa, Jan to Oct vs 2025	1,139 vs 1,202 GWh	−5.3%	Not recovered
Hotels, October vs 2025 (January was −31%)	17.3 vs 21.3 GWh	−18.8%	Recovering
Water supply, October vs 2025 (January was −21%)	19.9 vs 18.7 GWh	+6.4%	Recovered
RT10 customers at zero kWh vs pre-storm (Oct 2025)	58,886 vs 51,144	+15.1%	Not recovered
Residential in the west vs 2025 (Westmoreland −8%, Hanover −4%, St James −3%, St Elizabeth −2%)	west parishes	−3.5%	Not recovered

WHY THE WEST MATTERS

St James, Westmoreland, Hanover, Trelawny and St Elizabeth together ran −5.7% on last October, against a storm base that was depressed there, so the gap is real. Montego Bay commercial (hotels) is the largest piece: St James commercial is −15.7% on last year and −18.0% on budget.

SUGGESTED TESTS FOR RECOVERY

Hotels back inside 10% of last year once the December reopenings (1,982 rooms) land; the residential zero-kWh count back under 53,000; western residential back above last year. None of the three is in sight yet.

Year on year uses all billed volume including prepaid. Two-year view is postpaid only (no prepaid before 2025).

Where: parish, industry and KAM

Growth is concentrated in Kingston and St Catherine. St James and Clarendon are the two parishes pulling the other way, and each has a single explanation.

BY PARISH

Parish	Residential (RT10)			Commercial (RT20 to RT70)				Total vs 2025 (GWh)
	Oct 26	vs 2025	vs Sep	Oct 26	vs 2025	vs budget	vs Sep	
KSAS	9.2	+5.5%	−2.4%	46.8	+14.9%	+12.0%	+3.0%	+6.54
KSAN	21.7	+6.3%	−5.4%	30.9	+6.6%	+4.9%	+0.3%	+3.21
St. Catherine	13.7	+5.8%	−5.7%	22.1	+10.5%	+3.1%	+4.3%	+2.84
St. James	9.8	−2.6%	−7.8%	20.1	−15.7%	−18.0%	+1.0%	−4.02
St. Ann	7.2	+3.4%	−6.5%	11.9	0.0%	−4.7%	+0.7%	+0.23
Portmore	10.3	+3.3%	−6.2%	7.0	+4.5%	+0.4%	+34.6%	+0.63
Clarendon	6.5	+5.1%	−2.4%	9.3	−38.3%	−40.8%	−2.8%	−5.44
Westmoreland	4.3	−8.5%	−5.2%	9.5	−1.1%	−6.3%	−0.5%	−0.50
Manchester	5.7	+2.6%	−0.5%	5.9	+5.2%	+4.7%	+2.0%	+0.44
St. Elizabeth	5.2	−1.9%	−2.9%	6.4	+3.2%	+6.3%	+5.4%	+0.10
Trelawny	2.9	−0.3%	−7.9%	5.0	+8.1%	+1.8%	+3.5%	+0.37
St. Mary	4.5	+3.8%	−4.1%	3.1	+4.0%	−10.3%	−0.3%	+0.28
Portland	3.2	+6.2%	−2.9%	2.2	−1.3%	+2.9%	+4.8%	+0.16
St. Thomas	2.7	+6.9%	−5.5%	2.6	+8.5%	+6.4%	+3.0%	+0.38
Hanover	2.3	−4.5%	−2.5%	2.5	+1.9%	−3.5%	+9.0%	−0.06
Total	**108.9**	**+3.0%**	**−4.9%**	**185.4**	**+1.1%**	**−2.3%**	**+2.8%**	**+5.16**

Prepaid is allocated to its parish. Residential budget is not shown: it is allocated to parishes by formula and would mislead. Commercial vs budget is the account-level budget.

BY INDUSTRY (ACCOUNTS RT20 AND ABOVE), LARGEST CHANGES ON 2025

Industry	Oct 26	vs 2025	vs Sep	vs budget*
Mining (Alcoa)	3.0	−6.88	−0.02	−7.47
Cement Manufacturing	9.1	+4.78	−0.01	+0.78
Hotels and Motels	17.3	−4.00	+0.09	−3.91
Water supply and irrigation	19.9	+1.21	+1.36	−1.73
Food Manufacturing	4.2	+0.79	−0.15	+0.69
Contact centres	3.1	−0.62	−0.10	−0.53
Port and Harbor Operations	3.0	+0.49	+0.23	+0.58
Full-Service Restaurants	5.3	+0.41	+0.18	−0.07
Other Airport Operations	2.7	+0.37	+0.05	+0.17
Hospitals	4.2	+0.24	−0.09	+0.43
Colleges and universities	1.1	+0.18	+0.06	+0.21

*Budget compared only on accounts that have a budget line. Telecoms, executive offices and courts have many small unbudgeted accounts, so a plain comparison would overstate them.

BY KAM (ACCOUNTS WITH A NAMED KAM)

KAM	Oct 26	vs 2025	vs Sep	vs budget
Simone Chisholm	30.3	+1.08	+2.06	+5.61
Nicole Watson	18.2	+5.53	+1.53	+0.06
Tanya Williams	17.1	+0.99	−0.16	+4.05
Sheryl Davis	10.9	+0.03	+0.15	+1.93
Anna-Kay Toyloy	10.5	−2.10	−0.01	−0.67
Ewan Pitter	9.5	+0.99	+1.25	+2.17
Sharmica Holness	7.3	−6.45	−0.22	−6.64
Ruel Barnett	3.8	−2.05	+0.14	−1.74
Kenroy Williams	3.5	−0.03	+0.07	−1.01
Jean Waugh-Evans	2.8	+0.59	+0.24	+0.98

Sharmica Holness's gap against budget is Alcoa (its main account is −7.1 GWh). Budget is compared on accounts that have a budget line.

READ-ACROSS

- **St James** commercial is −15.7% on last year (−3.8 GWh). It is the hotel belt, and hotels are −4.0 GWh on last October.
- **Clarendon** commercial is −38.3% (−5.8 GWh): Alcoa's refinery. Mining is −6.9 GWh on last year.
- **Kingston South** commercial is +14.9% (+6.1 GWh), of which Caribbean Cement is +4.8 on a storm-hit base.
- **Portmore** commercial is +34.6% on September: Caribbean Broilers' main plant is billed there (+1.6 GWh), so it is billing timing, not growth. Petrojam does the same for Kingston South (+0.9 GWh).
- **Residential** is up in the east and centre (+5.0% on 2025) and down in the west (−3.5%).

Parish from the billing file; industry from the account register; KAM from the KAM assignments.

Drivers and the road to 2027

Residential fell 4.9% on September, all of it in the heavy-use bands, and commercial rose 2.8%, about half of it a rebound from September timing. Neither is a trend, and the 2027 plan leans on both.

RESIDENTIAL: WHERE THE FALL IS (OCTOBER VS SEPTEMBER)

RT10 band (kWh a month)	Oct GWh	vs Sep	Customers	vs Sep	vs 2025
Under 150 kWh	24.1	**+0.49**	322,349	**+6,265**	−3.6%
150 to 350	45.0	**+0.57**	202,160	**+3,392**	0.0%
350 to 550	16.8	**−1.60**	39,241	**−3,537**	+9.0%
550 to 750	7.1	**−1.73**	11,256	**−2,713**	+12.0%
750 to 950	3.7	**−1.09**	4,438	**−1,306**	+14.5%
Over 950	9.8	**−1.91**	5,725	**−1,396**	+14.9%
Prepaid	2.7	**−0.28**	18,090	**+66**	+18.1%

Customers using over 350 kWh fell by 8,952 and used 6.3 GWh less; the two lowest bands added 1.1 GWh. The fall is in the heavy users, which fits cooling load easing from September. The platform has no temperature data to confirm it.

COMMERCIAL: WHAT MOVED (SEPTEMBER TO OCTOBER, GWH, BY CUSTOMER)

Customer	Sep	Oct	Change	Read
National Water Commission	16.70	18.41	**+1.71**	water
Caribbean Broilers Ja Ltd	0.82	2.45	**+1.63**	timing
Petrojam Ltd	1.09	2.02	**+0.93**	timing
Ministry of Education	2.00	2.44	**+0.44**	trend or one-off
Windalco	1.90	2.22	**+0.33**	trend or one-off
PriceSmart (Jamaica) Ltd	0.61	0.88	**+0.27**	trend or one-off
Alcoa Mins Of Ja Ltd	0.82	0.39	**−0.44**	Alcoa exit
National Irrigation Commission	1.64	1.27	**−0.37**	water
CNX Services Jamaica ltd	0.32	0.16	**−0.16**	trend or one-off
West Meat Packers Ja Ltd	0.35	0.21	**−0.14**	trend or one-off

Net customer movement +5.2 GWh. Timing (Caribbean Broilers and Petrojam) is +2.6 GWh of it, 49%.

WHAT IS DRIVING EACH

- **Residential vs September (−5.6 GWh).** Seasonal, in the heavy bands, and deeper than 2024's −1.8% October move. Structural drags are small but real: net-export accounts are 857 against 501 last October, exporting 331 MWh against 94, and 7,742 more customers sit at zero kWh.
- **Residential vs the LE.** The LE has RT10 flat on September; the pattern in 2024 and 2025 is a fall. That is phasing, not weakness, but it carries into November and December.
- **Commercial vs September (+5.1 GWh).** Half is a rebound from a low September (Broilers, Petrojam), so October is a normal month, not a step up. National Water Commission's +1.7 GWh is the one rise that is not timing: it is 18.4 GWh against 17.3 and 17.2 in July and August, and water supply is +6.4% on last year. Whether it holds depends on pumping demand.

IF 2026 FOLLOWS 2024'S SEASONAL PATH (GWH)

Class	FY26 LE	FY26 replay	Gap	FY27 plan	vs LE	vs replay
RT10	1,222.8	1,192.9	**−29.9**	1,275.0	+4.3%	**+6.9%**
RT20	654.7	652.2	**−2.5**	691.6	+5.6%	**+6.0%**
RT40	771.9	784.8	**+12.8**	838.6	+8.6%	**+6.9%**
RT50	345.7	350.8	**+5.1**	400.8	+16.0%	**+14.3%**
RT60	37.5	37.9	**+0.5**	39.8	+6.2%	**+4.9%**
RT70	267.2	272.1	**+4.9**	193.7	−27.5%	**−28.8%**
System	**3,299.7**	**3,290.7**	**−9.0**	**3,439.5**	**+4.2%**	**+4.5%**

Replay = January to October actual plus November and December from October's level and 2024's October-to-December pattern for each class (RT70 held flat). One year's pattern, so a scenario, not a forecast.

Is it sustainable through 2027? Residential: not as planned. Commercial: yes, with two conditions. On the replay, FY2026 lands 9 GWh (0.3%) below the LE in total but with a different mix: residential and RT20 −32 GWh, large commercial +23. **Residential:** the November and December fall is seasonal and the LE does not have it, and FY2027 then needs RT10 growth of +6.9% on the replay base against the planned +4.3%. That leans on the 7,742 zero-kWh customers returning (worth roughly 1.3% of RT10 at the average 181 kWh a month) and on normal weather. **Commercial:** October is a clean base, so large commercial needs only +1.9% on the replay against +3.6% planned, provided the hotels reopen on schedule (1,982 rooms in December, 2,524 in the first half of 2027) and there are no further defections. Each 1% on residential is 12.8 GWh in 2027.

LE is the financials forecast held at 3,299.7 GWh for FY2026; FY2027 per the register.